Dalya Elmalt

Department of Economics
University of Wisconsin–Madison
1180 Observatory Drive, Madison, WI 53706

elmalt@wisc.edu
dalyaelmalt.com
Citizenship: Egypt

Education

University of Wisconsin–Madison
Ph.D. in Economics — Expected 2027
M.S. in Economics — 2024
Institute for Research on Poverty, Graduate Research Fellow

University of Chicago
M.A. in Social Sciences (Economics) — 2017
B.A. in Economics — 2016

Research Interests

Industrial Organization, Health Economics, Risk and Insurance Markets

References

Ashley Swanson (Advisor)
Professor of Economics

UW–Madison
608-262-5897
swanson25@wisc.edu

Alan Sorensen
Professor of Economics

UW–Madison
608-263-3867
sorensen@ssc.wisc.edu

Naoki Aizawa
Associate Professor of Economics
UW–Madison
608-262-9250
naizawa@wisc.edu

Job Market Paper

The Doctor's Pen and the Payer's Bargain: Insurer Ownership of Primary Care

Lawmakers are considering bans on insurer ownership of physician practices. Such vertical integration can be efficient, if it eliminates double marginalization or otherwise disciplines prices; consumers gain if the savings are passed through to premiums. It can also be harmful, through foreclosure of rival insurers or inflation of government subsidies. I study five such channels in one case study: a national insurer's 2020 acquisition of the largest primary care group in a local Oregon market, using all-payer claims from 2017 to 2023. On the side of efficiency, the integrated insurer does not obtain lower hospital prices at the dominant local hospital system, and although the acquired clinics refer its enrollees to specialists about 21 percent less often than rival insurers' enrollees at the same clinics, with no rise in emergency department visits or hospital admissions, its Medicare Advantage premiums do not fall relative to rivals'. On the side of harm, integration leads rival insurers to pay about 13 percent more for the same commercial office visit at the acquired clinics, and Medicare pays more for enrollees of the integrated insurer after the acquisition, while their use of hospital, emergency and specialist care and their total spending do not rise. In a market with hospital and physician concentration typical of the U.S., fragmented commercial insurers and high Medicare Advantage enrollment, I find these harms, and any savings were not passed on to consumers.

Working Papers

Hospitals, Insurers, and the Variation in Negotiated Prices: Evidence from Transparency in Coverage Data
ESG Investing: Only Part of the Climate Puzzle (with Deniz Igan and Divya Kirti)
CEPR Discussion Paper 16061, 2021; revised September 2023.
Earlier version: IMF Working Paper 21/112, "Limits to Private Climate Change Mitigation," 2021

Presentations

UW–Madison IO Workshop; International Monetary Fund

Teaching Experience

University of Wisconsin–Madison

TA, Principles of Macroeconomics – Carter Braxton	Spring 2025
Head TA, Principles of Microeconomics – Steve Trost	Fall 2023, Spring 2024, Fall 2024, Fall 2025, Fall 2026
TA, Principles of Microeconomics – Rebecca Glawtschew	Spring 2023
TA, Principles of Microeconomics – Steve Trost	Fall 2022

Research Experience

Research Officer, International Monetary Fund	2019–2021
Junior Research Scientist, Finance Department, New York University	2017–2019
Research Assistant, Energy Policy Institute at the University of Chicago	2015

Service

Co-organizer, Student IO Seminar, UW–Madison

Honors and Awards

Outstanding Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics, UW–Madison	2025
Jeff Metcalf Summer Research Award, University of Chicago	2015
Sawiris Scholar	2013–2016

Additional

Restricted-use data: Oregon All Payer All Claims database (APAC)
Programming: Python, Stata, R, Julia, SQL/DuckDB, Hadoop/MapReduce, LaTeX
Languages: Arabic (native), English (fluent)

Last updated October 2026